Harin Lee

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POSITIONS

Oct 2025 —	**University of Cambridge**, UK Junior Research Fellow at King's College on the topic of 'Rhythm'
Oct 2020 — Sep 2025	**Max Planck Institute for Human Cognitive and Brain Sciences (MPI CBS)**, Germany PhD in Cognitive Science. Thesis titled "Global Music Culture" supervised by Dr Marc Schönwiesner & Dr Nori Jacoby — Summa Cum Laude
Oct 2020 — Sep 2025	**International Max Planck Research Schools Fellowship (IMPRS NeuroCom)**, Germany Full-funding by the Max Planck Society on a competitive basis
Dec 2020 — Sep 2025	**Max Planck Institute for Empirical Aesthetics (MPIEA)**, Germany Visiting Researcher at the *Computational Auditory Perception* group led by Dr Nori Jacoby

EDUCATION

** Gap between MSc and PhD is due to serving the compulsory Korean military duties for two years*

	Goldsmiths College, University of London, UK
Oct 2017 — Oct 2018	MSc Music, Mind and Brain — Distinction
Oct 2013 — Sep 2017	BMus Popular Music — First Class
Other	TSE Summer School in Quantitative Social Sciences (2024), Diverse Intelligence Summer Institute Fellow (2022), Neuromatch Academy Summer School (2020)

PUBLICATIONS

*Joint First Authorship; †Joint Senior/Last Authorship

Ref. Journal Articles & Archival Conf. Proc

— 2026 —

van Rijn, P., Sun, Y., **Lee, H.**, Marjieh, R., Sucholutsky, I., Lanzarini, F., André, E., & Jacoby, N. (2026). One test, many tongues: Surveying language proficiency across the globe. Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (***PNAS***), 123(13), e2420179123. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2420179123

— 2025 —

Marjieh, R., van Rijn, P., Sucholutsky, I., **Lee, H.**, Jacoby, N., & Griffiths, T. L. (2025). Characterizing the Large-Scale Structure of Multimodal Semantic Networks. ***Cognitive Science***, 49(10), e70131. https://doi.org/10.1111/cogs.70131

Lee, H., Jacoby, N., Hennequin, R.†, & Moussallam, M.† (2025). Mechanisms of cultural diversity in urban populations. ***Nature Communications***, 16(1), 5192. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-025-60538-2

Lee, H., Çelen, E., Harrison, P. M. C., Anglada-Tort, M., van Rijn, P., Park, M., Schönwiesner, M., & Jacoby, N. (2025). GlobalMood: A cross-cultural benchmark for music emotion recognition. *Proceedings of the International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (**ISMIR**)*. https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2505.09539. — Best Student Paper Award.

Lee, H., Van Geert, E., Çelen, E., Marjieh, R., van Rijn, P., Park, M., & Jacoby, N. (2025). Visual and Auditory Aesthetic Preferences Across Cultures. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (**CogSci**).* https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2502.14439

Çelen, E., van Rijn, P., **Lee, H.**[†], & Jacoby, N.[†] (2025). Are Expressions for Music Emotions the Same Across Cultures? *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (**CogSci**).* https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2502.08744

Sguerra, B., Epure, E. V., **Lee, H.**, & Moussallam, M. (2025). Biases in LLM-Generated Musical Taste Profiles for Recommendation. *ACM Recommender Systems (**RecSys**).* https://doi.org/10.1145/3705328.3748030

— 2024 —

Marjieh, R., van Rijn, P., Sucholutsky, I., **Lee, H.**, Griffiths, T. L., & Jacoby, N. (2024). A Rational Analysis of the Speech-to-Song Illusion. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (**CogSci**).* https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2402.06992

Marjieh, R.*, Harrison, P. M. C.*, **Lee, H.**, Deligiannaki, F., Jacoby, N. (2024). Timbral effects on consonance disentangle psychoacoustic mechanisms and suggest perceptual origins for musical scales. ***Nature Communications***, 15(1), 1482. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-024-45812-z

— 2023 —

Lee, H., Hennequin, H, & Moussallam, M. (2023). Understanding individual and collective diversity of cultural consumption through large-scale of music listening events. *Proceedings of the Computational Humanities Research Conference (**CHR**).* — Best Paper Award. https://ceur-ws.org/Vol-3558/paper3539.pdf

Anglada-Tort, M., **Lee, H.**, Krause, A. E., & North, A. C. (2023). Here comes the sun: Music features of popular songs reflect prevailing weather conditions. ***Royal Society Open Science***, 10(5), 221443. https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.221443

van Rijn, P., Sun, Y., **Lee, H.**, Marjieh, R., Sucholutsky, I., Lanzarini, F., André, E., & Jacoby, N. (2023). Around the world in 60 words: A generative vocabulary test for online research. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (**CogSci**).* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2023.02.070

Anglada-Tort, M., Harrison, P. M. C., **Lee, H**., & Jacoby, N. (2023). Large-scale iterated singing experiments reveal oral transmission mechanisms underlying music evolution. ***Current Biology***, 0(0). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2023.02.070

Marjieh, R.*, van Rijn, P.*, Sucholutsky, I.*, Sumers, T., **Lee, H.**, Griffiths, T. L.[†], & Jacoby, N.[†] (2023). Words are all you need? Language as an approximation for human similarity judgments. *Proceedings of the International Conference on Learning Representations* (***ICLR***). https://openreview.net/forum?id=O-G91-4cMdv

— 2022 —

van Rijn, P.*, **Lee, H.***, & Jacoby, N. (2022). Bridging the prosody GAP: Genetic Algorithm with People to efficiently sample emotional prosody. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (**CogSci**).* https://escholarship.org/uc/item/59q714w6

— 2021 —

Lee, H., Höger, F., Schoenwiesner, M., Park, M., & Jacoby, N. (2021). Cross-cultural mood perception in pop songs and its alignment with mood detection algorithms. *Proceedings of the International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference* (***ISMIR***), 366–373. — Finalist for Best Paper Award. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5625680

— 2020—

Lee, H., Launay, J., & Stewart, L. (2020). Signals through music and dance: Perceived social bonds and formidability on collective movement. ***Acta Psychologica***, 208, 103093. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2020.103093

Lee, H., & Müllensiefen, D. (2020). The Timbre Perception Test (TPT): A new interactive musical assessment tool to measure timbre perception ability. ***Attention, Perception, and Psychophysics***, 82(7), 3658–3675. https://doi.org/10.3758/s13414-020-02058-3

In Review & Preprints

Lee, H.*, Anglada-Tort, M.*, Sobchuk, O., van Rijn, P., Schönwiesner, M., Tchernichovski, O.[†], Park, M.[†], & Jacoby, N.[†] Unsettled Times: Music Discovery Reveals Divergent Cultural Responses to War. *In Review,* preprint at https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/7b98u

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES & ACTIVITIES

Research Expedition
Jul 2025

Field Experiments, Bolivia
Conducted experiments across small-scale society Tsimané villages in the Bolivian Amazon — video documentation: https://youtu.be/JbWHa7KTeBg

Research Intern
May 2023 — Nov 2023

Deezer Research, Paris, France
Self-led project on understanding diversity in music listening.

Program Committee

Chair in Music for ISMIR 2025

External Reviewer

Journals: *Topics in Cognitive Science*; *Scientific Reports*; I*EEE Transactions on Affective Computing; Transactions of the International Society of Music Information Retrieval (TISMIR)*; *International Society of Music Information Retrieval (ISMIR)*; *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*; *Evolutionary Human Sciences; Psychology of Music; Music & Science*

Co-founder

***aiar* collective**, bridging neuroscience with music performance — www.aiarcollective.com

AWARDS & HONOURS

2025 **Best Student Paper Award**, Intl. Soc. of Music Information Retrieval (ISMIR)

2025 **Best Student Paper Award**, Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC)

2025 **Junior Research Fellowship**, King's College, University of Cambridge

2024 **Best Student Presentation Award**, Cultural Evolution Society Conf. (CES)

2023 **Best Paper Award**, Computational Humanities Research Conf. (CHR)

2023 **Nomination for Young Researcher Award,** Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC)

2023 **Travel Grant**, Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC) — $500

2022 **Scientific Research Fellow**, Diverse Intelligence Summer Institute (DISI) — $3,000

2022 **Art Grant** — Interactive Music Performance Using EEG, Leipzig City Council — €9,500

2021 **Nomination for Best Student Paper**, Intl. Soc. of Music Information Retrieval (ISMIR)

2021 **Nomination for Best Student Paper**, Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC)

2017 **Academic Excellence Scholarship**, Goldsmiths College — £3,000

2016 **Joe Brown Memorial Scholarship**, Music Department, Goldsmiths College — £500

INVITED TALKS

2025 **NLP4MusA Workshop, EACL 2026**, Morocco
Understanding music in the age of big data

2025 **MMB & PANC Talk Series, Goldsmiths, University of London**, UK
Aesthetic taste around the world

2025 **Spiers Lab, UCL**, US
Computing cultural taste

2025 **CAVA, Adobe Research**, US
Computing cultural taste

2025 **Imagination Seminar Series, Sogang University**, S.Korea
Computing cultural taste

2025 **Neuroscience of Perception & Action Lab, Italian Institute of Technology**, Italy
Computing cultural taste

2025 **Whitehead Lecture Series, Goldsmiths, University of London**, UK
Understanding music in the age of machine learning

2025 **Faculty of Music, University of Cambridge**, UK
Understanding music in the age of machine learning

2024 **Music Cognition Lab, Princeton University**, US
Global melody and rhythm reveal independent cultural clusters

2024 **Music Department, Durham University**, UK
Big data on music, implications and future outlooks

2024 **AI Robotics Group, KIST Korea Institute of Science and Technology**, S. Korea
Mechanisms of cultural spread and diversity through individual and population-level music patterns

2024 **Cognitive Ethnomusicology Special Interest Group, Bates College**, US
Global Pop: Studying the evolution of pop music across 51 countries since the 1950s

2023 **Evolution & Social Cognition Group**, **Ecole Normale Supérieure**, France
Understanding cultural diversity and spread through large-scale music listening behaviour

2022 **CompMusic Lab, Keio University**, Japan
Cross-cultural mood perception in pop songs and its alignment with algorithmic estimates

2022 **Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology**, Germany
GlobalPOP: Studying the evolution of pop music across 51 countries since the 1950s

2022 **Deezer Research**, France
GlobalPOP: Investigating the historical trajectories of popular music around the world

2022 **Brain Awareness Week Leipzig**, Germany
Without a song or a dance what are we?: Origins of music and how our musical perception is shaped by culture

CONFERENCES

2025 **Oral** — Intl. Soc. for Music Information Retrieval Conf. (ISMIR), Dajeon, S.Korea
2025 **Oral** — Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC), Sao Paulo, Brazil
2025 **Poster** — Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting (CogSci), San Francisco, US
2025 **Oral** — Explaining culture: an interdisciplinary approach, ENS, Paris, France
2024 **Oral** — Cultural Evolution Society (CES), Durham, UK
2024 **Oral** — Intl. Assoc. of Empirical Aesthetics (IAEA), Mallorca, Spain
2023 **Oral** — Computational Humanities Research Conf. (CHR), Paris, France
2023 **Oral** — Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC), Tokyo, Japan
2022 **Oral** — Cultural Evolution Society (CES), Aarhus, Denmark
2022 **Oral** — Systematic Musicology (SysMus), Ghent, Belgium
2022 **Oral & Poster** — Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting (CogSci), Toronto, Canada
2021 **Oral** — Intl. Soc. for Music Information Retrieval Conf. (ISMIR), Virtual
2021 **Oral** — Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC), Virtual
2020 **Poster** — Timbre 2020, Virtual
2019 **Oral** — Conf. on Interdisciplinary Musicology Embodiment Music, Graz, Austria

2019 **Poster** — Forum IRCAM Annual Workshop, Paris, France

PRESS HIGHLIGHTS

2024 **New Scientist** — 'Pythagoras was wrong about the maths behind pleasant music'.
https://www.newscientist.com/article/2419442-pythagoras-was-wrong-about-the-maths-behind-pleasant-music

2023 **BBC** — 'Have your say: Does the weather influence the music you listen to?'.
https://www.bbc.co.uk/newsround/65457387

2023 **PhysOrg** — 'New research shows how cultural transmission shapes the evolution of music'
https://phys.org/news/2023-03-cultural-transmission-evolution-music.html

TEACHING

2026 **Faculty of Music, University of Cambridge**
Lent-term postgraduate course: 'Global Musical Tastes in the Age of Big Data'

2025 **Tutorial, International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (ISMIR)**
3-hour tutorial on 'PsyNet: Collecting Large-Scale Behavioral Datasets for MIR Applications'

2024 **Department of Sociology, Seoul National University**
A 2-hour class on computational social science provided to Master's students

2021 **Department of Life Science, Leipzig University**
Seminar on deploying massive online experiments using PsyNet

SKILLS

Language & Software — R, Python, Javascript, HTML, SQL, Google BigQuery, AWS, HPC Computing, Gephi, Max MSP

Development — Author of **tptR** R package (https://github.com/harin-git/tptR)
Psychoacoustic experiments run on R to determine interindividual differences in timbre perception

Contributed to **PsyNet** (www.psynet.dev)
A platform for running large-scale online behavioural experiments enabling complex paradigms

Open Science — Along with my publications, I publish all analysis code and data on OSF (https://osf.io/ecrhs) and GitHub (https://github.com/harin-git)

REFERENCES

Dr Nori Jacoby (kj338@cornell.edu)
Assistant Professor, Department of Psychology, Cornell University

Dr Marc Schönwiesner (marcs@uni-leipzig.de)
Dean, Faculty of Life Sciences, Leipzig University

Dr Minsu Park (minsu.park@nyu.edu)
Assistant Professor, Social Research and Public Policy, NYU Abu Dhabi

RANDOM FACTS

I played on the stage of Berghain, Berlin, where I monitored the brain activities of producer EgreEgore in real time, feeding them back into the mix to manipulate the soundscapes and the underlying beats of the live performance. I've

released two electronic pop music albums, which are available on major streaming platforms (“Youth” by Harin and “In Dreams” by Computer Hope).